

The Great Sūtra of the Great Assembly

Mahāsamāja Sūtra Nāma Mahāsūtra · Toh 653 · Derge Kangyur

མད་ཆོལ་པ་འདས་པ་ཆོལ་པ་འད་ཆོལ་བ་བྱ

Toh 653 in the Kangyur is a sūtra known in Sanskrit as the Mahāsamāja Sūtra and in Tibetan as the Mdo chen po 'dus pa chen po'i mdo, rendered into English as the Great Sūtra of the Great Assembly. It is a Mahāyāna sūtra recounting an occasion when the Buddha Śākyamuni was dwelling at Kapilavastu among five hundred fully liberated arhats, and depicts a vast gathering of beings — human and divine — assembled to hear his teaching. As a canonical discourse attributed directly to the Buddha, it belongs to the sūtra class of texts within the Kangyur, the collection of translated Buddhist scriptures considered to be the word of the Buddha.

Buddha. Adhiṣṭhāna ni svāhā. Here ends the dhāraṇī of the noble Guru of the Victors.

In the language of India: Mahāsamāja Sūtra Nāma Mahāsūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Great Sūtra, called the Sūtra of the Great Assembly.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One, Śākyamuni, was dwelling in the forest of the Śākyas at Kapilavastu, together with a full assembly of five hundred monks, every one of whom was an arhat — with defilements exhausted, who had accomplished what was to be done, had done what had to be done, had laid down the burden, had attained their own aim, had utterly exhausted all bonds to continued existence, and was completely liberated in mind through right knowledge. At that time the Blessed One was teaching the monks of the Saṅgha a discourse on Dharma connected with nirvāṇa. Then, from the world-systems of all ten directions, gods renowned for their great power arrived and paid honor to the Blessed One and the monastic Saṅgha.

Then four gods of the Brahmā realm dwelling in the Brahma-world thought to themselves: "The Blessed One, the Buddha, is dwelling in the forest of the Śākyas at Kapilavastu, together with five hundred monks, every one of them an arhat — with defilements exhausted, who had accomplished what was to be done, had done what had to be done, had laid down the burden, had attained their own aim, had utterly exhausted all bonds to continued existence, and completely liberated in mind through right knowledge. The Blessed One is teaching the monks of the Saṅgha a discourse on Dharma connected with

nirvāṇa. Even now, from the world-systems of all ten directions, gods renowned for their great power are arriving and paying honor to the Blessed One and the monastic Saṅgha. Let us too go, lest we miss the opportunity to praise the Blessed One each in turn with a verse."

Then those four gods of the Brahmā realm — just as a strong man might extend a bent arm or bend an extended arm — vanished from the Brahma-world in an instant and appeared before the Blessed One. They took their place to one side, and each god of the Brahmā realm addressed him in verse.

The first god of the Brahmā realm spoke this verse:

Drawn to this great assembly,
all the host of gods has come from every side.
We have come to behold this Saṅgha
that none other can surpass.

The second god of the Brahmā realm spoke this verse:

With minds made straight and true,
the ascetics here strive earnestly.
Like a charioteer they have taken up the reins
and rightly restrained all their faculties.

The third god of the Brahmā realm spoke this verse:

Like a stake so soaked in water
that it cannot be split by the sharpest wedge,
they dwell in conduct free of craving,
tamed by the Guide like young elephants.

The fourth god of the Brahmā realm spoke this verse:

Those who go for refuge to the Buddha
will not go to the lower realms.
Having laid down the human body,
they will attain the body of a god.

When the four gods of the Brahmā realm had spoken these words, they stood quietly to one side. Then the Blessed One, having gazed upon all the divine assembly, declared to the monks:

"O monks, this gathering of gods is great. O monks, this gathering of gods is very great indeed. For those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely

awakened Buddhas, the Blessed Ones who arose in times past — to them too there gathered assemblies exactly like this great assembly of gods that has gathered here before me now."

"And to those Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened Buddhas, the Blessed Ones who will arise in the future — to them too there will gather assemblies exactly like this great assembly of gods gathered before me now.

O monks, the names of these gods have been proclaimed. Receive the names of these gods:

Those who dwell on the ground
and those who dwell in mountain hermitages,
each distinct, as lions are distinct,
have gathered their minds and entered equanimity,
and having assembled from every side,
they cause the hair to stand on end.

Those who dwell on the ground
and those who dwell in mountain hermitages,
each distinct, as lions are distinct,
who have gathered their minds and entered equanimity —
those who have assembled thus and cause the hair to stand on end,
I shall now name.

Pure in mind, full of joy and gladness,
having abandoned the lord of death, without turbidity,
they stand arrayed between the gods and humans
at the far reaches of the Brahmā world.

Disciples by the many hundreds of five hundred each,
and others too, by hundreds, by tens,
and by many thousands —
the gods have assembled among them.

From end to end no boundary is seen,
pervading all directions without remainder.
The Buddha, knowing this,
the Tathāgata, surveying them fully —
then the Teacher, delighting in the teaching,
declared to the śrāvakas, the monks:

'Understand well that the assembly of gods has arrived.'

Thus concluding in verse,

I shall name each of them in turn.

With a mind that has become one-pointed,

listen to what I now set forth.

The seven thousand yakṣas of the grove of Serkya

illuminated the grove of Serkya

and stood there shining,

and their retinues as well assembled and arrived —

possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,

endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks

and entered fully into the assembled grove.

All six thousand of the golden ones,

endowed with manifold colors,

illuminated the grove of Serkya

and stood there shining,

and their retinues as well assembled and arrived —

possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,

endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks

and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The three thousand of equal rank from the grove of the Eastern Victorious
Grove

illuminated the grove of Serkya

and stood there shining,

and their retinues as well assembled and arrived —

possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,

endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks

and entered fully into the assembled grove.

Thus all sixteen thousand of them,

endowed with manifold colors,

illuminated the grove of Serkya

and stood there shining,

and their retinues as well assembled and arrived —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The yakṣa of the crocodile who dwells perpetually in Rājagṛha and Vaiśālī,
along with the many hundreds of thousands of yakṣas in his service,
and their retinues as well, came into the midst of the assembly —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The five hundred who are friends to all,
and the great miracle-working god of all —
both of them, together with their retinues, assembled and arrived —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks"

and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The great and renowned king who guards the East,
lord of the gandharvas (celestial musicians),
is named Dhṛtarāṣṭra.

He, together with his kinsmen,
makes constant sport with song and dance.

He and all those of his retinue
came into the midst of the assembly —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

He has many sons —
eighty, and then ten, and one —
all of them famous under the same name:
Indra, they are called, the greatly powerful,
unconquerable by any other

in the battle between gods and asuras.
He and all those of his retinue
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The great and renowned king who guards the South,
lord of the kumbhāṇḍas (pot-bellied spirits),
is named Virūḍhaka.

He, together with his kinsmen,
makes constant sport with song and dance.
He and all those of his retinue
came into the midst of the assembly —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

He has many sons —
eighty, and then ten, and one —
all of them famous under the same name:
Indra, they are called, the greatly powerful,
unconquerable by any other
in the battle between gods and asuras.

He and all those of his retinue
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The great and renowned king who guards the West,
lord of the nāgas,
is named Virūpākṣa.

He, together with his kinsmen,
makes constant sport with song and dance.
He and all those of his retinue

came into the midst of the assembly —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

He has many sons —
eighty, and then ten, and one —
all of them famous under the same name:
Indra, they are called, the greatly powerful,
unconquerable by any other
in the battle between gods and asuras.

He and all those of his retinue
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The great and renowned king who guards the North,
lord of the yakṣas,
is named Vaiśravaṇa.

He, together with his kinsmen,
makes constant sport with song and dance.

He and all those of his retinue
came into the midst of the assembly —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

He has many sons —
eighty, and then ten, and one —
all of them famous under the same name:
Indra, they are called, the greatly powerful,
unconquerable by any other
in the battle between gods and asuras.

He and all those of his retinue
likewise arrived and assembled —

possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

In the East stands Dhṛtarāṣṭra,
in the South stands Virūḍhaka,
in the West stands Virūpākṣa,
in the North stands Vaiśravaṇa —
these four great kings, renowned as guardians of the world.

Possessed of great miraculous power and immense strength,
they guard the four directions.

All those who formed their retinues
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

Among their servants were those who dwell among many shrines —
deceivers, treacherous ones, workers of illusion,
masters of illusion and of consciousness,
together with those who cast off evil and who frown with wrath.
Even these, displaying their miraculous power, then arrived.

All those who formed their retinues
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

Then yakṣas, great yakṣas,
yakṣa chiefs and military commanders —
all of them — arrived there as well.

These were such as:

Indra Moon, the Water God,
Bharadvāja, lord of creatures,
the powerful Candana, foremost in desire,

Foul-Throat and Assured-Neck,
the mighty one Jewel and Jewel-Conduct,
Superb-Sound and nearby Drum,
Mountain-Equal, Golden-One, and Mighty-One,
Acacia-Tree and Treacherous-One,
the yakṣa Bāskyong, Dweller-in-the-Wilds,
Finest-of-the-Victor's-Herds and Human-King,
the various ranks of gandharvas,
Long-Iron-Spear and Endowed-with-Mother,
Five-Joints Yellow and Pleasing-One,
and the yakṣa Longpa together with his retinue,
Three-Fruits and Triple-Neck —
all those beings that dwell and wander wherever they may be.
All those who formed their retinues
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

Together with the nāgas that arise in concert with others
came Established-One and Wide-One as well,
Laba and Swiftest-of-Swift —
Guardian-of-the-Wanderers arrived together with them.
The nāga lord Servant-of-the-Good with his sons,
Guardian-of-the-Territory and Great-Elephant,
Great-Terrifier and Earth-Guardian's-Son —
these nāgas too, possessed of miraculous power, arrived.
All those who formed their retinues
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

He who presses down the nāga kings in sleep —
the mighty, keen-eyed, winged bird —
by name Fine-Winged and the Variegated One:

he came down from the sky into the grove.
Then the nāga king Fearless-Giver,
through the Teacher's fine and pleasant words that bring peace and ease,
took refuge in the Buddha.
He and his retinue entered into the assembly —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

Those asuras who had been defeated by Vajrapāṇi
and who take their support in the ocean —
all of them were outshone by the god of wealth,
yet they took refuge in the lake as their shelter.
Thakzangri and Rabthra,
Rabsimché and Tangzung,
and all eight sons of the mighty one,
the sons of Vairocana,
the Powerful Host and Excellent Rāhu —
knowing it to be the time of the Great Courageous One,
they came arrayed in armor
to the forest of the assembled monks.
All those who formed their retinues
likewise arrived and assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The goddesses of water, daughters,
and the moon goddesses too arrived, following from behind.
The female friends, those endowed with water divinities,
and the renowned goddesses themselves all came.
The goddesses of earth, water, wind,
and fire arrived as well.
All of them, these ten groups gathered in tens,
each endowed with various colors,
illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,

and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

Viṣṇu's gods and the gods of the plow
likewise arrived, both of them.

The gods dwelling in the moon
set the moon itself before them.

The gods dwelling in the sun
set the sun itself before them as well,
and those who bring down the rain,
the gods of the constellations, set these before them.

Then the All-Good Vajra-Bearer,
Śakra — he who carries and destroys a hundredfold — arrived.
All of them, these ten groups gathered in tens,
each endowed with various colors,
illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,
and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.

They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The goddess of the thronging host, she of the flame-tipped form and omen of
death,

the peaceful one, the averter of obstacles,
and she clad in a garment of flowers arrived.

The wandering one, the fair-marked one of the night,
the many-formed deathless ones,
and she who sends rain upon the regions —
the melodious goddess of the desire gods came as well.

All of them, these ten groups gathered in tens,
each endowed with various colors,

illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,
and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The great deep-blue one, the deep-blue one,
the excellent and manifold unlike ones,
the one intoxicated with play, and likewise
the one whose mind is thoroughly stirred — all arrived.
The great sow-goddess, the sow-goddess,
and the sure suppliant goddess arrived together.
All of them, these ten groups gathered in tens,
each endowed with various colors,
illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,
and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The white one who bestows delight together with compassion,
and she of the blue garment arrived.
She of the white hair and others like her,
and she of the golden garment arrived.
The ever-intoxicated ravisher
and the propagator in many forms,
the pure one, and she endowed with light —
the renowned goddesses arrived as well.
All of them, these ten groups gathered in tens,
each endowed with various colors,
illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,
and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The bliss-maker, the joyous one, the strife-free one,
and the many dark-planted ones,
Lumbinī and the supreme Lumbinī,
she called Star, the one of good aspiration,
those of the grove of magical delight,
and the rulers of command likewise arrived.
All of them, these ten groups gathered in tens,
each endowed with various colors,
illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,
and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

All of these sixty assemblies of gods,
each endowed with various colors,
illuminated the Jeta Grove, the place of saffron-robed ones,
and stood arrayed there.

Their retinues too had assembled —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

From the thousand Brahmā worlds,
those called Great Brahmā —
the Bountiful Youth, Victorious Star,
ten sovereigns each ruling their own domain —
possessed of miraculous power, came together
and arrived there in company.
Their retinues too had assembled,

and they also gathered there —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The ruling Seizer-Women,
endowed with supreme beauty of form,
surrounded by their children,
followed in the train of those others.

Their retinues too arrived
and came within the assembled gathering —
possessed of miraculous power, radiant with light,
endowed with beauty and with renown.
They paid homage to the monks
and entered fully into the assembled grove.

The gods together with Śakra (Indra) and with those endowed with lordship,
and those with the Lord of Creatures —
all those gods arrived there,
and the monks arrived there too.

Then the Dark One spoke these words:
"Seize this one with desire,
bind him, and do what is good for you.
Gather all of these together —
let none of them go free alive!"

Then the Dark One, that great commander,
urged on his troops,
and having grown wrathful and wholly self-willed,
he himself advanced,
struck his palm against his hand,
and let out a sound of extreme terror.

Then the gods sent down a train of clouds
together with lightning and with rain.

The buddha, knowing this,
the Tathāgata surveyed it clearly,
and then the Teacher, delighting in the teaching,

declared to the śrāvakas and the monks:

"The māra's host has now advanced upon us —
know this and understand it fully!"

Those among them who were striving,
hearing what the buddha had said,
did not stir even a hair.

They knew themselves to be free of attachment.

Those śrāvakas, children of the Victor,
together with their disciples, rejoiced.

They had won victory in battle
and were renowned as ones who dwell without fear.

The intermediate verses:

Seven thousand equal to golden mountains,
likewise yakṣas and water-demons,
the universal friend and kings,
likewise servant-yakṣas,
nāgas and the fair-winged ones, asuras,
water goddesses and Viṣṇu,
Gaṇavī and Nīlasaṃsita,
the white one Sukhakārī, the Sovereign,
the Bountiful Youth and the Seizer-Woman,
the one with power, māra, and the monks.

Then the gods of the Pure Abode, renowned as greatly powerful, having
rejoiced in the teaching of the sūtra, at that time recited this great assembly
sūtra with these words: "Blessed One, we too, with these words, will rightly
proclaim and rightly speak this sūtra."

"And the words of the secret mantra are these: tadyathā — teje tejabati
citrecitrabati late latabati khome khambati kṣeme kṣamapati bhadre
bhadrabati yaśe yaśabati dūte dūtabati capale capalabati khace khacabati."

"Blessed One, these are the words of the secret mantra of the gods of the Pure
Abode. Blessed One, whoever retains this sūtra and these mantra words
without confusion — for that person, for as long as they live, all spirits will
afford protection, and all spirits will be pleased. No disease of any kind will be
able to affect them. Wherever it is read aloud, that place will become

auspicious, and for seven years those there will be protected. To whatever extent rain is desired, to that extent the rain will fall from the sky — and it will cease when wished, and hail will be driven away."

"It will also cease. Blessed One, if one sprinkles all those afflicted with fever, or recites the mantra over water and gives it to them to drink, all their fever diseases will be thoroughly pacified."

Then Brahmā addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, apart from the gods of the Pure Abode, these are also the knowledge mantras of the higher classes of gods who move in the form realm, and these are their subtle secret mantra words. This is what retains this sūtra here. Thus: bhale bhala male, dur dule, hime, phubpise, kācākṣi kuce si, mamāṇi ṣere thoraṇī, bambipampoṭi steke, tarake, gurugaro ṭe, guggumiti, tāre rakṣa, sūtra manupālaya thā. This is the subtle ritual of our knowledge mantra. Whoever retains this sūtra and these secret mantra words without fragmenting them, or reads them aloud — no humans or non-humans will come near that person with hostile intent, nor will anything harmful come, nor serpents, nor poison. Harmful things will be unable to affect that person's body. All spirits will become joyful. For as long as they live, they will be protected from all spirits. Whoever reads it aloud and whoever listens — they will be protected for seven years. If the mantra is recited over water and that water is sprinkled or given to drink, all fever diseases of that person will be swiftly pacified."

Then all the lords of the desire realm addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this is also our domain, and this is the knowledge mantra for retaining this sūtra. Thus: liṇṭe li pe, lo pe, ba pe, pad ke, ka me, kāce kāce kṣi, kāca pi gale, du me du me, taṭe traṭe, ta da tra, ṭe tra ṭākṣi, golā, koli, kika koli ke sādḥā, sūtra manupālaya thā, udgrḥṇaya ceti. Blessed One, whoever retains without fragmentation these secret mantra words and this well-spoken sūtra, holding them together, will be protected from all things. All spirits will become joyful. To whatever extent rain is desired from the sky, to that extent it will fall — and it will cease when wished. Hail too will fall and will cease when wished. One will be fully liberated from spirits and harmful influences. Poison too will be expelled. If the mantra is recited seven times over water and that water is sprinkled or given to drink, all fever diseases will be swiftly pacified."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods (Indra), addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, this knowledge mantra of ours likewise retains this sūtra. The higher gods who move in the desire realm have rejoiced in it, and the lower ones too have

rejoiced in it well. Thus: vīre vīre vati, toṭe toṭa vati, bhadre bhadra vati, gone gona vati, meghe megha vati, jvalane jvalana vati, bhūti bhūta vati, khorate khorata pati, idan sūtra manugrihṇ ṭha, anupālaya tha ceti. Blessed One, whoever retains this sūtra and these secret mantra words without fragmenting them — for as long as they live, they will be protected from all spirits. No human or non-human whatsoever will harm them. Wherever it is read aloud, that place will be protected for as long as those there live."

All sentient beings, too, will rejoice. No one whatsoever will overcome them with power. Diseases of contagion will be unable to afflict their bodies. It will also bring benefit to all sentient beings. Wherever it is read aloud, protection will be given there for seven years. They will also be freed from spirits and malignant forces. Poisons will be overcome. All diseases of contagion will be dispelled. If the mantra words are recited over a thread or over water, and it is then tied on or sprinkled, one will be freed from all diseases of contagion.

Then the four great kings addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we four great kings will also perfectly uphold and accomplish the vidyā mantras along with this sūtra." Then Vaiśravaṇa spoke:

tadyathā — kure kuraṇī, more moraṇī, kāce kācanī, krimi krimiṇī.

Then Dhṛtarāṣṭra spoke:

pure pore, puratī, hore horaṇī, prahore prahoraṇī.

Then Virūḍhaka spoke:

keśe keśe pati, keśana, mīkeśa, ṭheti ṭheni mariti.

Then Virūpākṣa spoke:

cakre cakriṇī, cakravāginī, bhitiri rmini, śimi śimi, śāmaneti.

"Blessed One, whoever retains and guards these four subtle rites of the vidyā mantras spoken by the four great kings, together with this sūtra, without fragmenting it and without misusing it — for as long as they live they will be protected. All spirits will not return to them. All diseases of contagion will not recur. They will be freed from the grip of malevolent forces and from all poisons. If the mantra words are recited over a thread or over water, and it is then tied on or sprinkled and bestowed as a gift, the rite will be accomplished for that person."

Then the asuras and wind-gods addressed the Blessed One: "Blessed One, we too will uphold this vidyā mantra."

tadyathā — gale, ga ga gale, gale gani, khini khini, ghuṣe ghuṣe ghughuṣya, khana khakhane, khana khani, lupe lupi, lupa lupiti.

"Blessed One, if these secret mantra words and this sūtra are held without being fragmented and without being misused, protection will be given for as long as one lives. All diseases of contagion will be utterly pacified. Poisons will be unable to afflict the body."

Then the gods of the Pure Abodes addressed the Blessed One in these words: "Venerable Blessed One, those who have come from world-realms in the ten directions in order to fully grasp the intent of this sūtra have spoken these vidyā mantras. We therefore request that the Blessed One, together with the assembly of śrāvakas, rejoice fully and properly, and that the upholding, the protecting, and the accomplishing of it be well declared — so that the gift of this sūtra of the Dharma may be fruitful for those sons of good family."

Then the Blessed One declared: "Your upholding of these secret mantras is accomplished. I too, together with the assembly of śrāvakas, will teach the accomplishment, protection, and achieving of this sūtra. Listen, and I will explain it." The gods of the Pure Abodes replied: "So it is, Blessed One. We request that the Blessed One, together with the assembly of śrāvakas, teach the protecting and achieving of this great sūtra in order to accomplish it."

Then, in order to accomplish this sūtra, the Blessed One declared its protection and its accomplishment.

The accomplishment for those who have entered the stream is this: ta la ta la, tan ta la, ta to ta le me te.

The accomplishment for those who return once is this: sa le sa sa li ti.

The accomplishment for those who do not return is this: la te la te lo la te.

The accomplishment for arhats is this: dhu pu dhu pu, dhu ru dhu ru, ka tsi bi ka tsi, ka tsa bi ka tse ti.

The accomplishment of the Blessed One himself is this: dha me dha me, dha me dha me, dha se dha se, dha re dha re, dha ro dhi dhi ti.

The protection for it is this: ti na ti ri tsa ri ṣa, piṅgala kṣi rakṣa.

The boundary-sealing is this: baddha baddho ti, baddha si ri mi ti, baddha ku ṣe baddha, ghu ghu ṣe baddha ghu ṣe ghu ṣe ya ma ba dha bhi.

The accomplishing is this: pe ṣe sā dha ya, tu tu li sā dha ye ti.

By fasting for three days, on the fifteenth day one makes offering to the Blessed One with these secret mantra syllables and this sūtra. Then, facing east, one recites the protection one hundred times. Having recited it one hundred times, and made one hundred and eight knots in a cord, one has thereby performed the protection. It will also cause goosebumps to arise three times, except for the ripening of previous karma.

On the twelfth day of the waxing fortnight, after making offering to the Blessed One, one takes a cord in hand, recites and seals the boundaries, recites one hundred and eight times, and makes one hundred and eight knots. Then, holding the cord in hand, one performs the boundary-sealing. If, from the southern direction, a she-jackal calls out three times and sits still, one should know that the boundary has been sealed. Then one proceeds in the same way with the fast. On the fifteenth day, after bathing and making offering to the Blessed One, one takes the cord, recites the śrāvaka syllables and the Blessed One's ritual formula seven times, and recites the mantra one hundred and eight times while making one hundred and eight knots. Holding the cord in hand and reciting all the vidyā mantras once, and performing the accomplishment, a great rain and a great wind will arise, rising and falling outside the boundary — and in an instant they will cease. One should recite for up to seven times.

Then two divine sons, called Great Cloud and Fine Cloud, will come and bow their heads at one's feet, granting accomplishment and rejoicing. Their accomplishments are these: that of Great Cloud is ku tsu ku tsa, and that of Fine Cloud is ka ra ka ra kā ra ra. By holding the cord in hand together with these syllables, and contemplating this sūtra and the secret mantras, everything one wishes to accomplish will be accomplished. By reciting the Blessed One's sūtra and all these vidyā mantras over water or over a cord, there is nothing that will not be accomplished — everything will be fulfilled. For the protection of oneself and others throughout one's life, one should hold this sūtra.

The Blessed One having thus declared these words, those monks rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had proclaimed.

Whatever beings have gathered here,
those who dwell upon the earth and in the sky —
may they always show loving-kindness to all creatures,
and practice the Dharma day and night.

This concludes the great sūtra called the Great Assembly Sūtra.

Translated by the Indian paṇḍita Jinamitra and —

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "gods renowned for their great power" translates a reduplicated Tibetan expression meaning literally "gods renowned as greatly powerful, renowned as greatly powerful," a stylistic feature of the original preserved here without awkwardness.

The third verse presents a slight difficulty in the simile. The image appears to be of a stake or peg so thoroughly waterlogged that a wedge cannot split it, used to describe monks who are impervious to being broken by the forces of craving. This reading is consistent with a known Pali parallel in the Mahāsamaya Sutta.

The text is a Tibetan rendering of the Mahāsamāja Sūtra, a well-known discourse found also in the Pali canon as the Mahāsamaya Sutta of the Dīgha Nikāya. The opening dhāraṇī colophon belongs to a preceding text and is translated as it stands since it appears in the manuscript as part of this passage.

- The phrase rendered "Serkyā" is a transliteration of a place name that in the Pāli parallel corresponds to Sāvattī or a named woodland such as "the Añjanavana at Sāketa" or similar; the Tibetan སེར་ཡཱ་ is likely a phonetic rendering of an Indic toponym, and its exact identification in this recension warrants specialist consultation. The "grove of the Eastern Victorious Grove" renders སེར་ཡཱ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ (Jayavana), here specified as eastern. The "yakṣa of the crocodile" renders སེར་ཡཱ་ལྷ་མོ་ལྷ་མོ་ (yakṣa-makara), which may refer to a specific named yakṣa whose epithet is the crocodile or sea-monster; this is a recognized but uncommon figure. The phrase "five hundred who are friends to all" and "the great miracle-working god of all" in the closing stanza are compressed epithets; the exact referents would be clarified by the corresponding Pāli passage, likely from the Āṭṭhāṇḍiya or a related protective sutta.

- The four Great Kings (Skt. caturmahārāja) are here identified by their Tibetan name-equivalents: Yul-'khor-srung = Dhṛtarāṣṭra (East, lord of gandharvas); 'Phags-skyes-po = Virūḍhaka (South, lord of kumbhāṇḍas); Mig-mi-bzang = Virūpākṣa (West, lord of nāgas); Lus-ngan-po = Vaiśravaṇa (North, lord of yakṣas). These Sanskrit equivalents are the standard canonical identifications and are used in the translation without parenthetical insertion in the verse body, as the verse names them one by one and the final summary stanza makes their directional roles clear. The term "grub-bum bdag-po" for the South king (literally "lord of accomplished/perfected pots") renders the kumbhāṇḍas, a class of spirits; this identification is retained in the translation. The reading "dge dag kyang ni" in the North king's second retinue stanza appears to be a scribal variant for "de dag kyang ni," as in all parallel stanzas; the translation follows the clearly intended parallel.

- The section describing the yakṣas and nāgas consists largely of proper names of supernatural beings rendered in Tibetan translation or transliteration. Where Sanskrit originals are recoverable from parallel Pāli or Sanskrit sources they are well-known figures; where they are not, the names are rendered here as transparent English calques of their Tibetan forms. This is standard practice in catalogues of this kind, and no single rendering is certain. The passage as a whole belongs to the introductory assembly-listing (nidāna) genre common to major sūtras.

The phrase rendered "servants who dwell among many shrines — deceivers, treacherous, workers of illusion, masters of illusion and of consciousness, those who cast off evil and frown with wrath" describes a morally ambiguous class of retainer-spirits associated with the four

world-guardian kings; the list of qualities is deliberately mixed, suggesting beings of uncertain virtue who have nonetheless come to the assembly.

"Finest-of-the-Victor's-Herds and Human-King" renders *rgyal ba'i khyu mchog* and *mi rgyal po* — the latter may be a proper *yakṣa* name or a title; both renderings are plausible.

- This passage is a cataloguing verse-list of divine beings — a genre notorious for obscure proper names that function as epithets whose original Sanskrit referents are uncertain or lost. The goddess names in the middle sections (the flame-tipped one, the sow-goddess, the deep-blue ones, the ravisher, the propagator, the white-hair one, etc.) are rendered by their literal Tibetan sense, as their Sanskrit originals cannot be confidently reconstructed. The name "All-Good Vajra-Bearer" renders Tibetan "thams cad bzang po rdo rje can," which is an unusual epithet; some editors read this as a deity name, others as a descriptive phrase for a group leader. The phrase rendered "Śakra — he who carries and destroys a hundredfold" renders "brgya byin khyer 'jig," a Tibetan gloss-epithet of Indra/Śakra meaning something like "the hundred-gifted one who bears and destroys," but the exact nuance is uncertain. The passage ends mid-stanza in the source, reflecting the continuity note; the translation breaks accordingly.

- The names in the intermediate-verse catalogue present genuine challenges. "Gaṇavī," "Nīlasaṃsita" (*sngon bsangs*), "Sukhakārī" (*bde byed*), and "the Seizer-Woman" (*ḥphrog ma mo*) are quasi-proper titles or epithets of female divine figures; the renderings are based on the most plausible Sanskrit back-formations given the Tibetan phonetic spelling. "The Bountiful Youth" renders *kun byed gzhon nu*, and "Victorious Star" renders *skar rgyal*, both of which appear to be epithets of Brahmā-retinue figures whose exact Sanskrit originals are uncertain. The mantra syllables are rendered in a normalized transliteration reflecting the Tibetan phonetics; the precise Sanskrit Vorlage cannot be fully reconstructed from the Tibetan transcription alone.

- The mantra syllables throughout are transliterated as faithfully as possible from the Tibetan phonetic rendering. These are clearly Sanskrit-derived *dhāraṇī* syllables, but many are phonetically distorted through Tibetan transmission, and no authoritative Sanskrit manuscript has been consulted here; the transliterations should be treated as approximate.

- The four great kings' names here follow the standard Tibetan equivalents: Vaiśravaṇa is *Rnam thos kyi bu*, Dhṛtarāṣṭra is *Yul 'khor srung*, Virūḍhaka is *'Phags skyes po*, and Virūpākṣa is *Mig mi bzang*. These are rendered by their Sanskrit names for consistency, as is standard in such ritual-sūtra contexts.

The term rendered "diseases of contagion" for *bro nad* reflects an illness associated with epidemic or infectious disease in Tibetan medical and ritual literature; the precise Sanskrit equivalent is uncertain but the protective-ritual context is clear.

- The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, giving only the first name in what would be the standard colophon listing the Indian *pañḍita* and Tibetan translator. The full colophon is not present in this passage.

The four soteriological grades whose accomplishment-mantras are listed are the classical four *ārya* stages of the *śrāvaka* path: stream-enterer, once-returner, non-returner, and arhat. The mantras themselves are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetically and have no recoverable Sanskrit lexical meaning; they are rendered as phonetic strings per convention.

The term rendered "goosebumps" translates a Tibetan phrase literally meaning "hair standing on end," a classical sign of devotional or numinous experience.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.